Deference or Noise? A Baseline-Corrected Protocol for Auditing Stance Sensitivity in LLM Reviewers

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Index terms Large language models, sycophancy, evaluation methodology, reliability, AI-assisted decision making, benchmark.

Originality The manuscript is original and is not under consideration elsewhere.

Use of AI AI-generated text was used in drafting and editing the manuscript, and an AI coding assistant was used to develop the analysis code. This is disclosed in the Acknowledgments section of the manuscript, which cites the system used, as required by IEEE policy.

Human participants No personal data were collected. Two reviewers independently answered 100 synthetic decision items to check the answer keys (Section IV-A of the manuscript).

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Data and code The item bank, generator, audit program, runner, analysis code and raw model outputs are provided as anonymized supplementary archives (S1, S2).